Mountain View Historical Association Newsletter

P.O. Box 252
Mountain View, CA 94042

Hilton U. Brown, III - Editor



Southern Pacific Depot — Mountain View, California, built in 1888

Community Action
Your Police at Work
The February 1998 Meeting

The next meeting of the Mountain View Historical Association will be Sunday, February 1, 1998. The time is 2:00 P.M., and the place is the *Mountain View Senior Center*, 266 Escuela Avenue.

The speaker will be Sergeant Richard Elias, Community Action and Information Officer for the Mountain View Police Department. Sgt. Elias has more than a quarter century experience with the Mountain View Police Department and has long been known as the Department's "unofficial archivist," having rescued a large collection of old documents and photographs from oblivion.

Our *Old Newspaper Items* column has often included items about our early Town Marshals and other police activities. Now the Department is engaged in an effort to get Mountain View Residents more involved in policing themselves and the Police more involved with the life of the community. Called *Community Policing*, it is a concept of great importance to the future quality of life in Mountain View. One of Sgt. Elias's responsibilities is overseeing the *Citizens Police Academy* an exciting program which I am sure he will touch upon.

We are expecting a lot from St. Elias! The past, the present and the future of *law enforcement* in Mountain View! Please join us for the February meeting. As usual there will be refreshments afterwards.

A Celebration
The First 95 Years
The November 1997 Meeting

On Sunday, November 9, 1997 the Mountain View Historical Association and the City of Mountain View jointly celebrated the 95th anniversary of the day Mountain View became a Municipal Corporation. Celebrating a 95th birthday is a little unusual but Mountain View is a party town, and we enjoyed our 75th so much that we decided to celebrate every ten years. A "hidden agenda" reason for the celebration however, was as a sort of warmup and practice for the Centennial of Mountain View! The City and the Historical Association have begun thinking about the Centennial, and you may notice that the Executive Committee has started a review aimed at making all of our publications current and available by 2002.

Highlights of the meeting were a presentation by Barbara McPheeters Kinchen relating the history of the City, and the introduction of many of our past Councilpersons and other civic leaders. The first and second floors of City Hall were filled with exhibits of scenes from the City's past, and punch and cake made it into a very pleasant afternoon.

The 95th anniversary celebration followed by only two weeks the grand opening of the City's new Library. The Library includes greatly expanded and improved space for the *Mountain View History Center*, the new name for the Pioneer Room. As I said earlier, Mountain View is a great party town. Its time to start getting ready for a really big one, the ***Mountain View Centennial!***

The Mayfield Duel
by Candace Bowers

More than a hundred years ago, men from the nearby community of Mayfield were involved in a dispute over property rights that ended in an old-time duel and left three people dead. The Seale brothers, Thomas, Henry, and Joseph, had settled in the area and were involved in helping the Soto family of rancheros get a clear deed to their property – 2200 acres in what is now Palo Alto. In return for their help, the Sotos gave the brothers half their land. In 1858 or 59, Thomas Seale was involved in a dispute with brothers Paul and Richard Shore, who were squatting on Seale land in the Mayfield area. Seale and his hired man, Alexander Robb, went to Paul Shore's cabin to eject him. In the ensuing argument, Paul Shore was shot and killed. Thomas Seale immediately turned himself in to authorities in San Jose, claiming self defense. Also arrested as a accessory to the killing was Seale's friend Samuel Crosby, who underwent a preliminary examination and was discharged.

Several months later, Thomas Seale and Alexander Robb went on trial for the Shore killing, at the Courthouse in San Jose. Samuel Crosby was also present as a witness. Other supporters of Thomas Seale, as well as Shore's brothers Thomas and Richard, were gathered outside. Thomas Shore called out to Crosby in an apparent challenge to a duel. Crosby was mortally wounded, but not before he was able to fire a few haphazard shots. One of his bullets killed an innocent bystander miner from Grass Valley named L. Posey Fergusson. After firing the shot that killed Crosby, Thomas Shore fled and was never prosecuted – but the Shores vowed revenge on Thomas Seale.

Both Thomas Seale and Alexander Robb were acquitted of Paul Shore's killing. Seale left for Nevada and later lived in Australia. Years later he returned to live in the house that his brother Henry had built on Webster Street, near the Oregon Expressway. (This house later became an orphanage, and was destroyed in 1937.) When Thomas Seale died in 1907, it is said that Thomas Shore removed the gun he'd worn since the trial and said, "Sorry I never had a chance to use it."

Executive Committee Meeting
December 17, 1998

The Executive Committee of the Mountain View Historical Association met in one of the Community Meeting Rooms of the new Mountain View Library on December 17, 1997. The Financial and Membership Reports were reviewed and are reported in detail elsewhere in this Newsletter.

The Executive Committee decided to review and revise the existing published material of the Association with a goal of having the extended publication series ready to form a part of the City of Mountain View's 100th anniversary celebration.

The City appears to be looking favorably upon giving some sort of historic designation to the Adobe Building, and depending upon cost studies and the availability of funding, to preserving the building.

Copies of the minutes of the Executive Committee meetings are available from the Association's Secretary or from the Newsletter Editor.

Apologies

In the November 1997 issue of this Newsletter your Editor badly misspelled or mishandled three names:

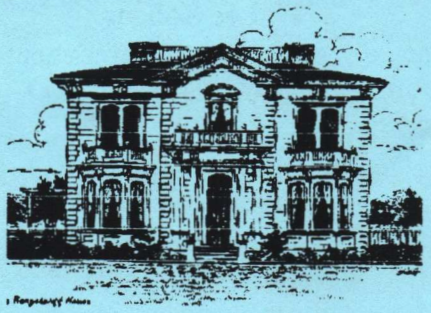
Mayor Bob Schatz
Helen Horton Madsen
H. Lee Stillens

I regret any discomfort or embarrassment that my poor proofreading may have caused. I will strive to do better.

In Commemoration

Harry W. True: 74, in Los Altos, December 17, 1997. A native of Mountain view and husband of Doris M. True of Los Altos. Father of Cyndi Patton of Scotts Valley, Barbara Willis of Mountain View and Patrick True of Napa. Brother of Virginia Lopez of Stockton, grandfather of five and great-grandfather of two. Owner of True Construction, his grandfather was an early contractor here. He was a former Mountain View Councilman, a member of BPOE # 1471, a veteran of World War II and a member of the Mountain View Historical Association

Ralph W. Holtzclaw: 77, in Sutter Creek, July 4, 1997 of cancer. Survived by his wife of 52 years, Jeanne Jurian Holtclaw of Sutter Creek, his children Kevin Holtzclaw of Monroe, CT., Joanie Hall of Pine Grove, CA, and Tricie Harrington of Mountain View, eight grandchildren and two great grandchildren. Born in Missouri, Mr. Holtzclaw was a graduate in Aeronautical Engineering from the University of Washington. He was employed at Moffett Field by the National Advisory Committee for Aeronautics 1941-1958 and then by NASA until his retirement in 1979. He was Pioneer Spacecraft Systems Manager and Branch Chief for many of the Pioneer Space Missions. He was a recipient of the NASA Exceptional Service Medal and a Medal for Outstanding Leadership. Jeanne Holtclaw was the Librarian in Charge of the Mountain View Library Pioneer Room for many years. Ralph was a long time member of the Mountain View Historical Association.



Anouncements

From the Membership Chair:
Members who paid their dues for 1998 may pick up their Membership Cards at the February Meeting. If you want your card mailed to you please send a Self Addressed Stamped Envelope to *Mountain View Historical Assn., P.O. Box 252, Mountain View, CA 94042.* Thank you.

From the Executive Committee
We made $55.00 from the sale of postcards and booklets at the 95th Celebration. We also earned a substantial amount thru our volunteer work in conjuction with the Small Brewers Assn. There will be opportunities in the near future for the membership to volunteer, and it pays off!

Mountain View History Center
(formerly the Pioneer Room)
New Schedule:
Tuesday - Thursday - Saturday
1-5 P.M.
Wednesday
5-9 P.M.

OLD NEWSPAPER ITEMS BY BARBARA KINCHEN

100 Years Ago (1898): Ads appeared for property in the new town at Murphy Station, named Encinal (now Sunnyvale). The town already has a general store, blacksmith shop, wine warehouse, Post-office and telephone station.

A tenant farmer was suing the owner of the land for $1,000 because the landlord's cattle got loose and ate the hay and barley crop.

Knapp Brothers are putting in an irrigating outfit on their place in Old Mountain View – the very first attempt at irrigating in this section.

Plans are underway to lay bituminous rock on Castro Street from Front Street to Dana.

75 Years Ago (1923): "Women are great gossips, but did you ever listen to a group of men in a barber shop?"

Town Marshal Ernest Copp patrols at night for rats using his two dogs.

A successful raid on bootleggers and proprietors of places where large stocks of wine and brandy were kept netted seven men and over 4,000 gallons of wine and "Jackass brandy."

P G & E is laying a gas main from Mayfield to Mountain View along the highway. By March a lateral will be completed to the business district.

Whisman Road, which leads to South Sore Port (the old Jagel's Landing), will be improved. The channel has been dredged, wharves and warehouses built and a boat is under construction for daily trips to San Francisco. Trucks will be used to deliver freight to any place in the county.

A new building is being constructed on Dana Street for the Bloemer Corduroy Pants Factory.

50 Years Ago (1948): Palo Alto Hospital reported that 302 Mountain View babies were born there in 1947, 34 of these were to service families.

Foundations were being laid for the new school on Escuela Avenue. It was expected to be named for Kenneth N. Slater, Superintendent of Schools, until he stated that he would not consent to that under any conditions.

Forty-two cases of whiskey were missing after a burglary at the Old Corral on Bayshore Highway.

From the Greyhound Bus Station at 216 Castro Street one could travel to Reno for $4.25 or to Los Angeles for $5.10. Round trips were even lower.

The cost of milk went up to 20¢ a quart in stores for grade A and 20½¢ delivered.

Because of severe drought conditions in northern California, P G & E asked for customers to cut back 20% on use of electricity. In rural sections power was cut off periodically for 30 minutes at a time and factories and industries were compelled to close down one day a week.

Quota Club, a service organization for women, has organized a local group and received its charter from Quota Club International, Inc.

Over 30,000 were expected to tour the Freedom Train during the 12 hours it would be stopped in Palo Alto. Sponsored by the American Heritage Foundation, the train carried important documents, including Jefferson's original rough draft of the Declaration of Independence, and letters by Washington, Jefferson and Lincoln. Mountain View High School was to close for the day so students could attend and the band was to entertain those waiting to board the train.

25 Years Ago (1973): Students and teachers of Awalt High School helped Chester F. Awalt celebrate his 90th birthday. Awalt served 48 years on the Board of Trustees for the High School District.

Samuel Leong received the Chamber of Commerce Distinguished Citizen Award.

Meyer Electric moved into the former J.C. Penney building on Castro Street. The appliance company

has been in Mountain View for 27 years.

The old Ice and PreCooling Plant at Mariposa and the railroad tracks, due to be torn down, was badly damaged by fire.



SAVE
THE
ADOBE

Membership Report
by Edna Thompson

A list of members of the Mountain View Historical Association is available to members from the Chair of the Membership Committee. Dues are $ 7.00 per year for an individual or $10.00 per year for a family, and Life Membership is $100.00 per person.

Life Members	56
Special Members	2
Honored Member	1
Individual and Family Members	207
Total Members	266

New Members (Since August)
- David Guzman (Gift from John Henning)
- Mickey Hobbs
- John McGowan
- Massimo Prati
- John Wasniewski
- Gilda and Irwin Wunderman

New Life Members
- Carole Fischer
- Donald M. Holt
- Virginia M. Holt
- Milan Popovich
- Denise Williams

Association Officers and Board Members

President	Ralph Faravelli
Past President & Social	Wally Erichsen
Vice President	Arthur Walton
Secretary	Eva Mockbee
Treasurer	June de Larios
Membership	Edna Thompson
Newsletter & Program	Hilton Brown
Hospitality	Mary Esther Walton
Memorial/Remembrance	Margaret Peterson
Ways & Means	Joseph Sweeney
Historical Data	Barbara Kinchen
Amplification/Recording	Albert Jehning

Regular meetings of the Mountain View Historical Association are held on the first Sunday of February, May, August and November. The Newsletter is mailed approximately two weeks before each meeting. Deadline for copy for the Newsletter is the third Sunday before each meeting. Short items on appropriate topics submitted by any member of the Association will be considered for publication.

Life Members

Mario Ambra
Lawrence Anderson
Dena K. Bonnell
Hilton Brown
Reynolds Camp
Cliff Del Carlo
Alfred P. Chasuk
Ruth Erichsen
Wallace Erichsen
Carmen Faravelli
Ralph Faravelli
Roger Fellows
Patricia Figueroa
Carole Fischer
Marion Grimm
Estelle Stagg Heffelfinger
Bill Henderson
Eleanor McGlynn Henderson
Charles Hirschbek
DeWitt Hogle
Norene Hogle
Alice D. Holden
George Holden
Donald M. Holt
Virginia M. Holt
George Jagels
Al Jehning
Robert W. Kirby
Joe Kleitman
Helen Shearer Krogh
Holly Urban Moore Leonard
Kenneth Richard Malovos
Madeline Chargon Malovos
Eva Mockbee
Gail Urban Moore
Mimi Mourkas
Milan Popovich
Patricia J. Reyburn
Elaine Marcetti Shearer
Nancy L. Smith
Richard M. Smith
Martin J. Spangler
Honor Spitz
J. R. Stafford
Brigitte Stafford
H. Lee Stillens
Linda Swan
Joseph Sweeney
Roberta Sweeney
Edna Thompson
Sally Moore Taboada
John Viscovich
Arthur Walton
Patricia Walton
Denise Williams
Bill Wissell

Treasurer's Report
A.J. De Larios
October 1, 1997 – December 31, 1997

Balance 10/1/97		$11,618.31
Income:		
Membership	864.00	
Sales	809.00	
Adobe Fund	10.00	
Memorial Fund	0.00	
Interest	17.75	
Total Income		1700.75
Expense:		
Administration	410.73	
Adobe	9.11	
Total Expense		419.84
Balance 12/31/97		12,899.22
Fund Balances:		
Adobe Fund	2,604.32	
Memorial Fund	275.00	
Life Member Fund	5,600.00	
General Fund	4,419.90	

Investment:
$5,000 CD, Renewed at 5.40%, matures 7/98

Mountain View Historical Association

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Regular Meeting

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Sunday, February 1, 1998
2:00 PM
Senior Center - 266 Escuela

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Topic and Speaker
Community Action Your Police At Work

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Presented by
Sgt. Richard Elias
Community Action & Information
Mountain View Fire Department

MEMBERSHIP: Any person who signifies interest in the aims of this Association and who pays the specified annual dues may become a member of the Association.

AIMS: The aims of this Association are: to gather and preserve historical data relative to the early settlement and development of the area in and around the present City of Mountain View; to collect, record, edit and publish a history of the pioneering activities of this area; to preserve historic objects and places; to cooperate with other organizations in the Santa Clara Valley on projects deemed worthy by our membership.

MEMBERSHIP APPLICATION

NAME: _____

ADDRESS: _____

_____

_____

TELEPHONE: _____

TYPE: NEW___RENEWAL____

REGULAR MEMBER $ 7.00/YR
FAMILY MEMBERSHIP $10.00/YR.
LIFE MEMBER $100.00.

MAKE CHECK PAYABLE TO:
MOUNTAIN VIEW HISTORICAL ASSOCIATION
P.O. BOX 252, MOUNTAIN VIEW, CA 94042

SAN FRANCISCO, CA 941
PM
19 JAN
1998

GIVE TO UNITED CEREBRAL PALSY
HELP DISABLED PEOPLE
USA 32

MOUNTAIN VIEW HISTORICAL ASSOCIATION
P.O. BOX 252
MOUNTAIN VIEW, CA 94042

FIRST CLASS MAIL

